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Trump: US seizes Iranian cargo ship

Capture of vessel near Strait of Hormuz puts new talks in doubt

By Michelle L. Price, Samy Magdy and Sam Metz
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The United States said it attacked and seized an Iranian-flagged cargo ship that tried to get around a naval blockade near the Strait of Hormuz on Sunday, the first interception since its blockade of Iranian ports began last week.

Iran will respond soon, its state broadcaster said later, calling the armed boarding an act of piracy.

The events threw into question both the fragile ceasefire and President Donald Trump's earlier announcement that U.S. negotiators would head to Pakistan on Monday for another round of talks with Iran. The ceasefire is set to expire by Wednesday, and Washington and Tehran's standoff over the strait has now sharpened.

Trump on social media said a U.S. Navy guided missile destroyer in the Gulf of Oman warned the ship, the Touska, to stop and then “stopped them right in their tracks by blowing a hole in the engine-room.” U.S. Marines had custody of the U.S.-sanctioned vessel and were “seeing what’s on board!”

The U.S. Central Command, which didn’t answer questions, said the destroyer had issued “repeated warnings over a six-hour period.”

There was no comment from Iranian officials on Trump’s announcement of the talks. However, Iranian state media, without citing anyone beyond unnamed sources, issued brief reports suggesting that they would not happen.

Oil prices rose in early trading Sunday as the standoff prevented tankers from using the strait. The price of U.S. crude oil increased 6.4% to \$87.88 per barrel after trading resumed on the Chicago Mercantile Exchange. The price of

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INSIDE

Depleted FBI, DOJ scramble to rebuild

The federal agencies must rebuild their workforce after a wave of departures over the past year, with leaders easing hiring requirements and accelerating recruitment in ways that some current and former officials see as a lowering of long-accepted standards. **Nation & World, B1**

Democrats revive talk of using 25th Amendment

Despite long odds, push to remove Trump keeps focus on his behavior

By Daniel C. Vock
FOR THE CHICAGO TRIBUNE

WASHINGTON — A long-shot idea Gov. JB Pritzker and others previously floated took on new life earlier this month when Illinois Democrats joined dozens of colleagues from across the nation in demanding President Donald Trump’s closest allies remove him for being “unable” to carry out his duties.

The Republican president’s recent behavior has raised doubts even among some staunch allies,



A cyclist looks at the flooding from the Des Plaines River on Joseph J Schwab Road in Des Plaines on Saturday. CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE

Week of storms leaves wreckage, rising rivers

Intense weather fuels 15 tornadoes across Illinois; waterways expected to crest

By Adriana Pérez and Christiana Freitag
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Beginning a week ago, what the local National Weather Service office called “an incredibly active stretch of weather” — including record-breaking rainfall and large hail — culminated Friday with more than a dozen tornadoes across northern and central Illinois. As water levels in area rivers kept rising over the weekend, the ripple effects of the severe storms are continuing into this week.

Residents across northern Illinois and northwest Indiana will also wake up Monday morning to widespread freezing conditions.

The Des Plaines River is expected to crest, or reach its highest peak, at 18 feet on Monday morning before gradually receding, according to data from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration’s National Water Prediction Service. Even so, expected levels remain below the river’s record crest of 20.9 feet near the city of Des Plaines, set in 2013, according to NOAA data. Intense rains also pushed the Des Plaines, Chicago River and other waterways to near-record levels in 2020.

Other Chicago area rivers continue to experience flood-



An aerial view shows damage from Friday’s tornado in Lena. SCOTT OLSON/GETTY

ing. The Fox River is forecast to reach 11.9 feet on Thursday at the Algonquin tailwater in McHenry County. The river’s record was 13.2 feet in April 2023.

Chicago is now experiencing its second-wettest spring on record and its rainiest April since

2013, according to the University of Illinois State Water Survey. As climate change intensifies, the air in the Midwest is becoming more saturated with humidity, a key ingredient of strong thunderstorms that can produce tornadoes.

Researchers also say the region is seeing more tornadoes, and tornado season is beginning sooner and lasting longer.

As of Sunday afternoon, National Weather Service

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Names of dead on jury list could have wide impact

After problem found in Whiteside County, questions arise about Illinois juror pools

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

James Mertes sees dead people — on a court jury list.

Mertes, a criminal defense attorney, was alarmed by the glut of dead people whose names turned up on a recent list of potential jurors in rural Whiteside County. Now, he and county prosecutors are wondering whether Illinois has sufficient safeguards to purge the deceased from its jury pools.

The issue could potentially affect other criminal trial cases — making the case the “canary in a coal mine” for the statewide jury system, Mertes said.

“It’s extremely difficult to believe this problem doesn’t exist in other counties,” Mertes said. “Our system of justice is predicated on the idea that a jury represents a fair cross section of the community, so you get different perspectives. Then you can have faith in the integrity of that verdict.”

Whiteside County State’s Attorney Colleen Buckwalter has conceded the problems with the jury pool process, and has stated in court that her office has not been given any guarantee that the pool is purged of those who’ve passed away.

At issue is the Sixth Amendment right to “an impartial jury.” The U.S. Supreme Court has interpreted that to mean the pool from which jurors are chosen should be a “fair cross-section” that is “broadly representative

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President Donald Trump speaks to reporters at Joint Base Andrews in Maryland on April 12. TIERNEY L. CROSS/THE NEW YORK TIMES

yet invoking the U.S. Constitution’s 25th Amendment to have Trump ousted — a process that would require Vice President JD Vance, a majority of Trump’s Cabinet and supermajorities in both chambers of the Republican-controlled Congress to support ousting Trump — has almost no chance of happening short of a health crisis.

But that was never really the point.

While there’s little expectation Trump’s inner circle will turn on him, Democrats can keep Republicans on the defensive about the president’s aberrant behavior with a debate over Trump’s ability to

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